

Student Guide — primary / module-13- indic-ecology

IKS Curriculum

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Student Workbook

Student Workbook — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary)

This workbook is yours to write in. Use it for vocab, exercises, and reflection across all 10 days.

Vocabulary tracker

Fill in as we go:

- *Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam* — _____
- *yajña* — _____
- *ahiṃsā* — _____
- *devarakāḍu* — _____
- *sthāvara-jaṅgama* — _____

Day-by-day notes

Day 1 — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 2 — Five Elements as Ecological Frame

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 3 — Rivers as Sacred

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 4 — Sacred Groves

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 5 — Yajña — The Ecological Cycle

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 6 — Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1)

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 7 — Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 8 — Climate Change — The Crisis

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 9 — From Ancient to Action

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 10 — Project Pitch and Assessment

What I learned:

One question I have:

Final reflection

After Day 10, write a paragraph: what is the most important thing you learned in this module?

Day 1 — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Identify the source verse and explain the principle.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam* (IAST: Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam; lit. “the world is one family” — Mahā Upaniṣad 6.71”)

Introduce the concept gently using a story, a drawing, or a sensory example. The concept for today: **Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam**. Keep sentences short.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 2 — Five Elements as Ecological Frame

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Link Module 2 pañcabhūta to ecology — interconnection.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *yajña* (IAST: yajña; lit. “cycle of giving and receiving (BG 3.10–14)”)

Introduce the concept gently using a story, a drawing, or a sensory example. The concept for today: **Five Elements as Ecological Frame**. Keep sentences short.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

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- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 3 — Rivers as Sacred

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Discuss the ecological function of river-worship traditions.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *ahimsā* (IAST: ahimsā; lit. “non-violence; extended to non-human life”)

Introduce the concept gently using a story, a drawing, or a sensory example. The concept for today: **Rivers as Sacred**. Keep sentences short.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 4 — Sacred Groves

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Identify devarakāḍu and similar groves as biodiversity reserves.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *devarakāḍu* (IAST: devarakāḍu; lit. “sacred grove (Karnataka, S. India)”)

Introduce the concept gently using a story, a drawing, or a sensory example. The concept for today: **Sacred Groves**. Keep sentences short.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

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- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 5 — Yajña — The Ecological Cycle

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Read BG 3.10–14; map yajña to natural-cycle reciprocity.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today’s idea (10 min)

- *sthāvara-jaṅgama* (IAST: sthāvara-jaṅgama; lit. “immobile (plants, rocks) and mobile (animals) life”)

Introduce the concept gently using a story, a drawing, or a sensory example. The concept for today: **Yajña — The Ecological Cycle**. Keep sentences short.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

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- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 6 — Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1)

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Read the Earth-mother hymn and discuss imagery.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today’s idea (10 min)

- *Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam* (IAST: Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam; lit. “the world is one family” — Mahā Upaniṣad 6.71”)

Introduce the concept gently using a story, a drawing, or a sensory example. The concept for today: **Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1)**. Keep sentences short.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

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- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 7 — Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Translate *īśāvāsyam idam sarvam* and discuss its ecological implication.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *yajña* (IAST: yajña; lit. “cycle of giving and receiving (BG 3.10–14)”)

Introduce the concept gently using a story, a drawing, or a sensory example. The concept for today: **Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic**. Keep sentences short.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

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- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 8 — Climate Change — The Crisis

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Summarise key IPCC findings; what is changing and why.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *ahimsā* (IAST: ahimsā; lit. “non-violence; extended to non-human life”)

Introduce the concept gently using a story, a drawing, or a sensory example. The concept for today: **Climate Change — The Crisis**. Keep sentences short.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

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- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 9 — From Ancient to Action

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Design one local environmental project applying an Indic-ecology principle.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *devarakāḍu* (IAST: devarakāḍu; lit. “sacred grove (Karnataka, S. India)”)

Introduce the concept gently using a story, a drawing, or a sensory example. The concept for today: **From Ancient to Action**. Keep sentences short.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 10 — Project Pitch and Assessment

Module: Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Present project pitches; summative quiz.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today’s idea (10 min)

- *sthāvara-jaṅgama* (IAST: sthāvara-jaṅgama; lit. “immobile (plants, rocks) and mobile (animals) life”)

Introduce the concept gently using a story, a drawing, or a sensory example. The concept for today: **Project Pitch and Assessment**. Keep sentences short.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Sacred Grove (or Local Ecology) Mapping* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

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- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Homework

Homework — Indic Ecology — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam (Primary)

Light daily tasks. Each takes 5–10 minutes.

1. **Day 1 — Vasudhaiva Kuṭumbakam** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
2. **Day 2 — Five Elements as Ecological Frame** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
3. **Day 3 — Rivers as Sacred** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
4. **Day 4 — Sacred Groves** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
5. **Day 5 — Yajña — The Ecological Cycle** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
6. **Day 6 — Pṛthivī Sūkta (AV 12.1)** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
7. **Day 7 — Iṣopaniṣad — Non-Greed Ethic** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
8. **Day 8 — Climate Change — The Crisis** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
9. **Day 9 — From Ancient to Action** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
10. **Day 10 — Project Pitch and Assessment** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)

Notes

- Homework is intended to consolidate what was learned in class, not introduce new content.
- If a child struggles, the parent should consult the teacher rather than push.
- Capstone project days (Module 15) may have lighter daily homework so students can focus on the project.